MIL-C-6235D
18 June 1970
SUPERSEDING
Used in Lieu of
Spec MIL-C-006235C
9 September 1968
and MIL-C-6235A
9 June 1954

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

COMPASS, MAGNETIC, UNMOUNTED, POCKET, SURVIVAL

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a pocket compass for use as a component of survival kits.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

MMM-A-250	Adhesive, Water-Resistant, (for closure of Fiberboard Boxes)
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676	Boxes, Setup
PPP-T-76	Tape, Pressure-sensitive Adhesive Paper (for Carton Sealing)

Military

MIL-C-17504	Coating Compound, Acrylic clear
MIL-M-19590	Marking of Commodities and Containers to Indicate Radioactive Material

STANDARDS

Federal

No. 595	Colors

FSC 6605

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Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-143	Specifications and Standards Order of Precedence for the Selection of
MIL-STD-831	Test Reports, Preparation of

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS Title 10 (Atomic Energy).

(Application for the above publication should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

INTERSTATE COMMERCE COMMISSION

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS Title 49, Transportation

Agent T.C. George's Tarriff No. 23 Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles by Land and Water in Rail Freight Service and by Motor Vehicle (Highway) and Water, Including Specifications for Shipping Containers.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 First article. This specification makes provisions for first article inspection.

* 3.2 Selection of specifications and standards. Specifications and standards for necessary commodities and services not specified herein shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-143.

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* 3.3 Materials. The materials shall be as specified herein and as shown on the applicable figures. Where a definite material is not specified, it shall be in accordance with the best commercial practice and shall be entirely suitable for the compass construction. Nonmagnetic materials shall be used for all parts, except pivots, magnets, and other parts for which ferrous materials are essential.

* 3.3.1 Brass. The compass case shall be fabricated of best commercial brass entirely suitable for the purpose.

* 3.3.2 Plastic. The plastic used in fabrication of the cover (crystal) shall be polymethylmethacrylate or other acrylic polymer or copolymers containing such additions necessary for compliance with this specification. The plastic material shall give a product which is clear, transparent, and colorless.

* 3.3.3 Luminous material. The luminous material shall be a paint consisting of phosphor, a radioactive material and a binder. The isotope promethium-147 or hydrogen-3 shall be used as the radioactive material. The amount of promethium isotope used to obtain the desired brightness shall not exceed 0.4 millicurie per compass and the amount of hydrogen-3 shall not exceed 10 millicuries per compass. The luminous paint shall be used within 40 days of its formulation.

* 3.4 Design and construction. The compass shall be a sealed source and shall be as shown in figures 1 and 2, and shall consist of a brass case containing the compass card, covered with a clear plastic top. The case shall be furnished with a heavy duty retainer ring securely affixed to the case. A three-foot length of 45-pound braided nylon fishline, olive drab, or green color, shall be threaded through the ring, and the ends tied to form a necklace.

* 3.4.1 Case. The case shall be fabricated of the best commercial grade of brass (3.3.1) and shall permit satisfactory card tilt as specified herein.

* 3.4.1.1 Finish. The brass case shall be given an adherent finish coat of lusterless paint after cleaning and pretreatment. The point shall be olive drab. Color No. 34087 of FED-STD-595.

* 3.4.2 Sealing gasket. The sealing gasket shall be applied between the plastic cover and the brass case before swaging of the case: The gasket shall insure water-tightness of the case.

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* 3.4.3 Cover. The plastic cover (3.3.2) shall be affixed in place and sealed for water-tightness. Legibility of the card markings shall not be distorted by the cover. It shall be clear and free from flaws and strain, and shall not become opaque or craze on aging.

* 3.4.4 Lubber line. The lubber line shall be approximately 1/64 inch in width and shall be a straight line passing through the center of the inner surface of the plastic cover. The lubber line shall be filled with luminescent material (3.3.3).

3.4.5 Card assembly. The card assembly shall be as light in weight as practicable and sufficiently rigid to withstand service use.

3.4.5.1 The card shall be graduated in 22-1/2° marks (16 points) equally spaced to represent the horizontal angle within an accuracy of 1° left or right.

3.4.5.2 Magnet. The card magnet shall be constructed of a suitable magnet or cobolt steel and shall be suitable heat treated, magnetized to saturation, and aged to insure permanence. The magnet shall be securely attached by riveting and cementing.

3.4.5.3 Pivot. The card pivot shall be constructed of a suitable alloy of high grade steel properly hardened and polished on its working surface.

3.4.5.4 Cup jewel. The cup jewel shall be constructed of glass free from surface flaws and shall have a snug fit in the jewel retainer.

3.4.5.5 Color. The color of the card assembly shall be dull black.

* 3.5 Markings. Letters and graduations shall distinctly indicate the direction intended. The arrow marking indicating north direction and the other three cardinal point markings shall be made with luminous material. The other graduations shall be white in color. The lubber line of the underside of the cover shall also be filled with the luminescent material (3.4.4).

* 3.5.1 Luminous marking characteristics. The luminous markings of the compass, as shown by the cross-hatching in figures 1 and 2, shall be made with the luminous paint of 3.3.3. The fluorescent color of the luminous paint shall conform to Table I.

Table I. Green fluorescent color

Characteristic	Minimum	Maximum
Dominant wavelength (millimicrons)	500	600

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*3.5.1.1 Brightness. The markings on the compass card and compass cover shall have a minimum photopic brightness of 10 microlamberts at the time of manufacture. After 300 days, the photopic brightness must be a minimum of 7 microlamberts.

*3.5.2 Adaptation to exposure. The luminous paint shall be adapted for exposure to air and water. It shall be resistant to high and low temperature changes, submersion, and other environmental tests specified in sampling plan B of section 4. The luminous markings shall be coated with a 50% solids solution of an acrylic lacquer conforming to MIL-C-17504.

3.6 Performance.

3.6.1 Card error. Card error shall not exceed 5° when the compass is rotated in increments of $22\text{-}1/2^{\circ}$.

3.6.2 Rotation time. The card shall rotate through an angle of 90° in an average time of not less than 1-1/2 seconds nor more than 5 seconds.

3.6.3 Tilt. There shall be no restrictive action on the card when it is subjected to a maximum tilt of 8°.

3.6.4 Damping. The card shall not overswing its equilibrium position more then 80°, when rotated 180°.

3.6.5 Swirl. The maximum deflection of the card shall not exceed 5° upon completion of a 360° turn in one minute.

*3.6.6 Low temperature operation. The compass, after being subjected to a temperature of minus 65° Fahrenheit (F) for 24 hours shall operate satisfactorily.

*3.6.7 High temperature exposure. No damage shall occur to the compass when it is subjected to a temperature of 155°F. for a period of 2 hours at a pressure of 30 inches of mercury.

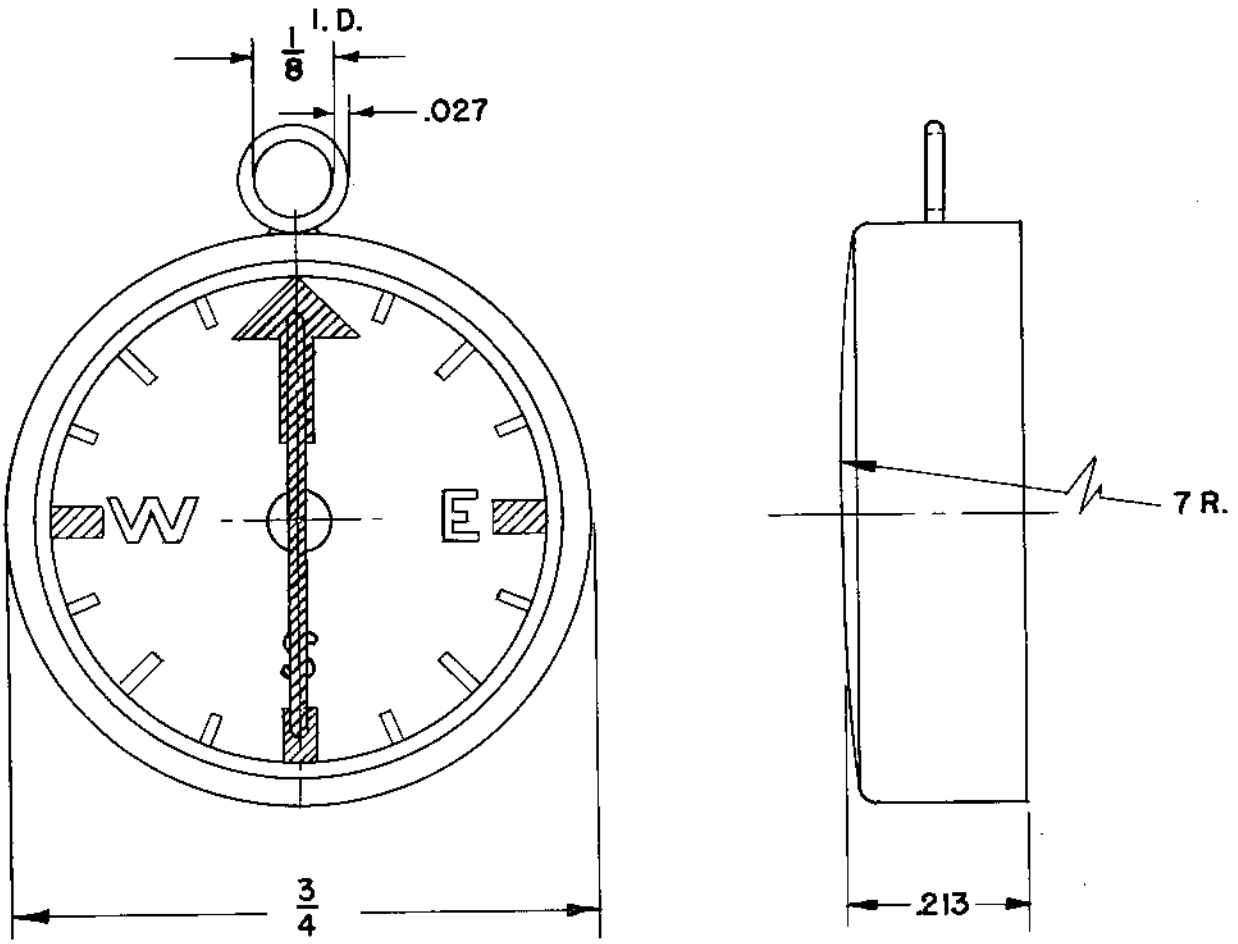
*3.6.8 Variable pressure exposure. The compass shall operate satisfactorily after testing as described in 4.6.3.3.

*3.6.9 Low pressure exposure. The compass shall operate satisfactorily after being subjected to an absolute pressure of 5.54 inches of mercury as described in 4.6.3.4.

3.6.10 Drop resistance. The mechanism of the compass shall not be damaged when it is dropped from a height of 5 feet onto a hard wood surface. The compass shall operate satisfactorily after testing.

3.6.11 Submersion. The compass shall not be affected in any manner by being immersed in salt water as described in paragraph 4.6.3.6.

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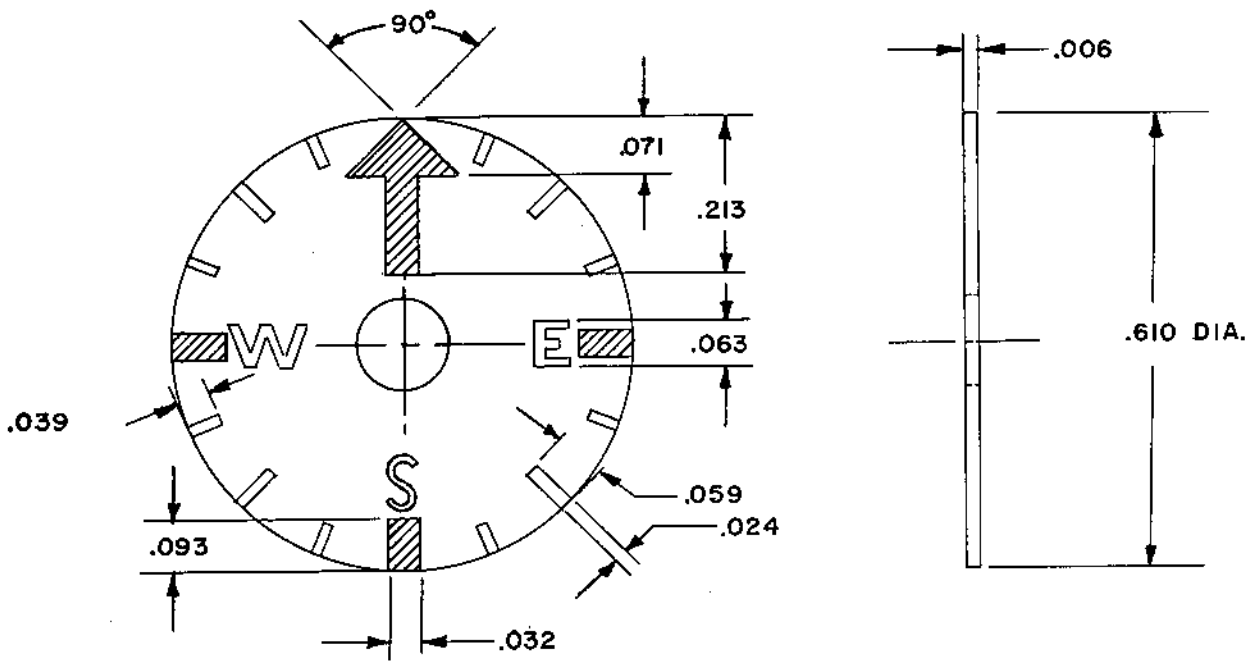
DIMENSIONS IN INCHES
UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED.
TOLERANCES:

ANGLE ± 2
DECIMALS ± .002
FRACTION ± 1/32

COMPASS

FIGURE 1.

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NOMINAL SIZE $\frac{3}{4}$

DIMENSIONS IN INCHES
UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED
TOLERANCES:

ANGLES $\pm 2°$
DECIMALS $\pm .002$

COMPASS CARD

FIGURE 2

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*3.7 Toxic radiological requirements. Luminous materials and techniques of manufacture shall not introduce health hazards resulting from the use or storage of the compass.

*3.7.1 Radiation level. The radiation at the surface of the compass shall not exceed 1.25 milliroentgens per hour when tested as specified in 4.6.6.

*3.7.2 Removable surface contamination. Removable surface radioactive contamination shall not exceed 2200 disintegrations per minute when tested as specified in 4.6.7.

*3.8 Identification markings. The compass shall be permanently stamped, marked or labeled with the following according to the isotope used.

pm - 147 0.4 mc	H-3 10 mc
month and year	month and year
AEC license number	AEC license number
Radiation symbol	Radiation symbol

An instruction sheet shall be folded and sealed with the compass into the polyethylene bag (5.1.2.1) so that there is no substantial increase in size of the unit package. The instruction sheets shall be worded as follows:

"Do not tamper with compasses in any way, do not attempt to repair damaged or broken compasses, but dispose of as radioactive waste, as per applicable service regulations. Return excess serviceable compasses to unit supply organization."

3.9 Workmanship. All parts, components and assemblies of the compass including molded parts, stamplings, and machined surfaces shall be clean and free from dirt, oil, fins, pits, spures, scale, and flux, and other harmful extraneous material. All edges shall be rounded or beveled.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

*4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

*4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification is defined as both examination (such as visual, auditory, and investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection of compasses shall be classified as follows:

a. First article inspection
b. Quality conformance inspection

4.3 First article inspection.

4.3.1 Test sample. The first article sample shall consist of ten (10) compasses which are representative of the production items. Each of the samples shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.3.3.

4.3.2 Test report and test samples. When the tests are conducted at a location other than the laboratory of the procuring activity, three copies of the test report in accordance with MIL-STD-831, and the samples which were tested shall be furnished.

4.3.3 First article tests. The first article tests shall consist of the following tests conducted in the order listed.

a. Radiological contamination test
b. Radiation level test
c. Visual inspection
d. Fluorescent color test
e. Environmental tests
f. Operational tests
g. Brightness test

4.3.4 First article approval. Written approval of the first article inspection shall be obtained from the procuring activity prior to the submission of subsequent items to fulfill the contract or order.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance shall be based on the following.

a. Sampling plan A
b. Sampling plan B

4.4.1 Sampling plan A. A random sample of compasses shall be selected from each inspection lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level III, acceptable quality level 1.5 percent defective. They shall be subjected to the following tests as described under 4.6.

a. Visual inspection
b. Operational tests

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4.4.2 Sampling plan B. Five (5) compasses shall be selected at random from each lot of 500 or fraction thereof and subject to the tests listed below. The acceptable quality level is 1.5 percent defective in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The tests as described in 4.6 shall be conducted in the following order:

a. Radiological contamination
b. Radiation level
c. Fluorescent color
d. Environmental tests

4.5 Test conditions.

4.5.1 All tests shall be conducted in the absence of ferrous metals.

4.5.2 Unless otherwise specified, tests shall be made at atmospheric pressure (approximately 29.92 inches Hg) and at room temperature (approximately 25° C).

4.6 Test methods.

*4.6.1 Visual inspection. The compass shall be visually examined to determine conformance with the construction and marking requirements specified in section 3.

4.6.2 Operational tests.

4.6.2.1 Card error test. Card error shall be determined by aligning the zero heading of the compass with the zero index of a suitable turntable and then rotating the compass through 360° increments of 22-1/2°, the increments being read on the turntable scale. The error shall be determined by the amount the compass card differs in reading from that of the turntable scale reading. The card error shall not exceed 5°.

*4.6.2.2 Rotation time test. The compass shall be placed in a flat position, face up, and rotated through an angle of 90°. The average times of two observations, right or left deflection, shall be calculated. The average time shall be not less than 1-1/2 seconds not more than 5 seconds.

4.6.2.3 Tilt tests. The compass shall be placed at a maximum horizontal tilt 8° and rotated 360° around a vertical axis. Any visual indication of restrictive action constitutes a failure.

*4.6.2.4 Damping test. The compass shall be subjected to a 180° angle turn. The card shall not overswing its equilibrium position by more than 80°.

4.6.2.5 Swirl test. The compass shall be subjected to a 360° turn at a uniform rate of 360° per minute for one minute. The maximum deflection of the card shall not exceed 5°.

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4.6.3 Environmental tests. Upon completion of the environmental tests the compass shall pass operational tests of 4.6.2.

* 4.6.3.1 Low temperature test. The compass shall be subjected to a temperature of -65°F for 24 hours. The compass shall then be observed for satisfactory operation.

* 4.6.3.2 High temperature test. The compass shall be subjected to a temperature of 155°F at ambient pressure for a period of 2 hours and inspected for any evidence of damage.

* 4.6.3.3 Variable pressure test. The compass shall be placed in a pressure container and subjected to an absolute pressure of mercury from 29.92 to 5.54 inches at room temperature 25°C ± 10°C. After a few seconds, the pressure shall be returned to 29.92 inches and the compass shall be removed and examined for satisfactory operation. Pressure change rate shall not exceed 0.5 inch of mercury per second.

4.6.3.4 Low pressure test. The compass shall be subjected to an absolute pressure of 5.54 inches of mercury for a period of one hour and then inspected for evidence of changes.

* 4.6.3.5 Drop test. At normal room temperatures, the compass shall be subjected to a drop from a height of 5 feet onto hardwood surface such as hardwood flooring. Two drops shall be with the compass held parallel to the floor, one-face up and one-face down and two drops shall be with the held perpendicular to the floor, one-ring down, one-ring up. The compass shall operate satisfactorily upon completion of the test.

* 4.6.3.6 Submersion test. The compass shall be submerged in salt water, at room temperature, (25°C ± 10°C), for a period of not less than 12 hours. The salt water solution shall be prepared by dissolving 5 grams of U.S.P. sodium chloride in 100 milliters of distilled water. Any indication of leakage or damage after removal from the water will constitute a failure.

* 4.6.4 Fluorescent color. The compasses shall be compared visually with source and filter combinations yielding the dominant wave lengths. When filter-source combinations are too bright to permit convenient matching, a neutral filter may be used. Evidence of fluorescent color values not within the limits specified in table I shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.6.5 Brightness. The brightness shall be determined by either the Comparison method in 4.6.5.1 or the Visual photometric method in 4.6.5.2 below.

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* 4.6.5.1 Comparison method. The brightness of the luminous material shall be determined by a comparison method using photoelectrical photometry. Brightness standards with the same spectral characteristics as the luminous material shall be used to calibrate the photometer. The standards shall have been determined by visual photometry by the National Bureau of Standards or by other approved testing facilities within the previous six months. Prior to the measurement of the luminosity of the compass, the photometer shall be calibrated with the standards in a dark room. The meter deflections corresponding to brightness values specified in 3.5.1.1 shall be determined. The compass undergoing test shall not be exposed to light during the comparison test or during the preceding 24 hours.

* 4.6.5.2 Visual photometric method. The brightness value of the compass shall be measured with a visual photometer with a split field of view. Prior to measurements, the photometer shall be calibrated in a dark room by a technician who has been darkness adapted for a minimum of 30 minutes. Calibration shall be with the proper light source. The compass shall not be exposed to light for a period of 24 hours preceding the test or during the test. Evidence of brightness values not within the limits specified in 3.5.1.1 shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.6.5.3 Decrease of brightness. The brightness of a compass shall also be measured 300 days after the initial measurement using the same test as for the initial brightness measurement. Photopic brightness of less than 7 microlamberts will constitute failure.

4.6.5.3.1 The test of 4.6.5.3 may be waived by the contracting officer upon certification by the vendor that items of the same model as those to be furnished under this specification have passed the tests of 4.6.5.3. Also the contractor must certify that the compasses being supplied were manufactured under essentially the same processes as those previously tested and will meet the requirements of 3.5.1.1.

* 4.6.6 Radiation level. The radiation level from all surfaces of individual compasses shall be measured with a Geiger-Muellar type survey meter using a probe with an end mica window of 1.2 to 1.8 mg/cm^2 thickness. Evidence of the radiation level in excess of the requirement of 3.7.1 shall constitute failure of test.

* 4.6.7 Removable surface contamination. Wipe test shall be made of source cover, front, back, and sides with moist filter paper and the wipe shall be analyzed for radioactive content. Radiological contamination in excess of 2200 disintegrations per minute at 90% confidence level will constitute failure of test.

* 4.7 Inspection of the preservation, packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage. Sample items or packs and the inspection of the preservation, packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the requirements of section 5, or the documents specified therein.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.1.1 Unit of issue. Each compass, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

* 5.1.2 Level A.

* 5.1.2.1 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in a minimum size, clear, polyethylene bag having an average wall thickness of 0.003 inch. Closure of bag shall be effected by heat sealing to prevent moisture from affecting the contents. The compass shall be further packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676. Closure of carton shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

* 5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. One hundred unit packages shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Boxes shall be closed by taping the top and bottom flaps with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

* 5.1.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

* 5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A.

* 5.2.1.1 Exterior container. The compasses shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, table II, using type I, class I plywood; or PPP-B-621, table III. The gross weight of each box shall not exceed 200 pounds. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification

* 5.2.2 Level B.

* 5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, table I, using type III, class 1 plywood; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Bursting strength of fiberboard box shall be in accordance with special requirements of table I of PPP-B-636. The gross weight of each wood box shall not exceed 200 pounds. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

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* 5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

* 5.3 Marking.

* 5.3.1 Interior packages. Interior packages shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and MIL-M-19590, type II. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

* 5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and MIL-M-19590, type II. In addition, exterior container shall be marked in accordance with T.C. George's Tarriff No. 23 and shall have labels to indicate the following:

(1) Finder return to nearest Military Installation.

(2) Interior and Exterior containers of compasses will bear the following markings:

'DO NOT STORE OR EXPOSE THIS CONTAINER OR ITS CONTENTS IN AREAS WHERE AMBIENT TEMPERATURE IS EQUAL TO OR GREATER THAN 150 DEGREES FAHRENHEIT."

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Compasses covered by this specification are intended for use in survival kits.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Where first article is to be sent.
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Definitions

6.3.1 Mechanism. The internal components of the compass contained within the case and lens.

6.3.2 Hardwood surface. A solid wood surface with a minimum thickness of 1 inch such as oak flooring.

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*6.4 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Army - ME
Air Force - 71

Preparing Activity
Air Force - 71

Project number
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MIL-C-6235D

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